

TYPICAL TITS

These small, acrobatic, usually hole-nesting birds of the family Paridae occur in wooded habitats across North America, Eurasia, and Africa. They frequently hang upside down to glean insects from foliage, and manipulate seeds and nuts to crack them open.

12–14 cm
4¾–5½ in

VARIED TIT

Sittiparus varius

This species is found in forest habitats, including conifers and bamboo forests, in N.E. Asia, Japan, and Taiwan.

12–15 cm
4¾–6 in

BLACK-CAPPED CHICKADEE

Poecile atricapillus

A typically inquisitive and acrobatic tit, this is a common N. American bird. Like other tits, it hoards seeds for later use.

GREAT TIT

Parus major

Widespread across Eurasia, this tit occurs in habitats from forest to heathland, and has a diverse range of vocalization.

14 cm
5½ in

14–16 cm
5½–6½ in

TUFTED TITMOUSE

Baeolophus bicolor

Like other tits, this eastern N. American species supplements its insect diet with seeds, holding them firmly to smash them with its bill.

11–12 cm
4½–4¾ in

BLUE TIT

Cyanistes caeruleus

This common bird of broadleaf woodlands in Europe, Turkey, and N. Africa is a frequent visitor to bird feeders in gardens.

PENDULINE TITS

These small, needle-billed birds from the family Remizidae occur in Africa and Eurasia, with one species in America. Most use cobwebs and other soft material to build flask-shaped nests that hang from branches, often over water.

11 cm
4¼ in

PENDULINE TIT

Remiz pendulinus

The only member of the family to have a wide range across Eurasia, this species occurs on marshes with trees, where it builds its pendulous nest.

9–11 cm
3½–4¼ in

VERDIN

Auriparus flaviceps

Unlike most other penduline tits, the verdin makes a spherical nest. It is found in desert scrub of the S. USA and Mexico.

BIRDS-OF-PARADISE

Mainly found in the rainforests of New Guinea, members of the family Paradisaeidae are mostly fruit-eating birds. The males display their bright, gaudy plumes in elaborate courtship displays, and spend most of their energy on this mating ritual, leaving the females to rear the young alone.

32 cm
12½ in

LESSER BIRD-OF-PARADISE

Paradisaea minor

This species occurs across N. and W. New Guinea. Males use their long, yellow flank plumes and distinctive cape for courtship displays.

yellow flank plumes

AUSTRALIAN ROBINS

The Petroicidae are chunky, round-headed insect-eaters. Unrelated to the robins of Europe or America, they are found from Australasia to the islands of the southwest Pacific. Some exhibit co-operative breeding, in which young birds help their parents to raise a new brood.

13 cm
5 in

JACKY WINTER

Microeca fascians

This common robin uses its broad bill for fly-catching. It is widespread in woodland throughout Australia and New Guinea.

15 cm
6 in

EASTERN YELLOW ROBIN

Eopsaltria australis

Common in the woodlands and gardens of E. Australia, this bird sallies from low perches for invertebrates, which it snatches from the ground.

WAXWINGS

From the family Bombycillidae, these berry-eating birds are named for the waxy, red-tipped shafts on their wings. Three species occur in the cool northern forests of North America and Eurasia.

waxy red shaft on wing

yellow tip to tail

18 cm
7 in

BOHEMIAN WAXWING

Bombycilla garrulus

This sleek bird is pinkish brown, with chestnut undertail feathers. It breeds in northern taiga forest and is attracted to berried shrubs during its migration south.

LONG-TAILED TITS

Birds of the family Aegithalidae are small, restless insect-eaters that build dome-shaped nests that are woven with cobwebs and lined with feathers. Most species are found in Eurasia, with one occurring in North America.

14 cm
5½ in

LONG-TAILED TIT

Aegithalos caudatus

The most widespread long-tailed tit, this woodland bird inhabits a range from N. to C. Eurasia, gathering in restless flocks when not breeding.

SILKY FLYCATCHERS

The family Ptilonotidae from Central America has just four species. These birds are named for their soft plumage (similar to that of related waxwings) and their feeding habits.

PHAINOPEPLA

Phainopepla nitens

This bird of the S. USA and Mexico nests colonially in woodland, but is territorial when breeding in deserts.

18–21 cm
7–8½ in